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Oversight body beset with division tied to blitz

Commission looking at CPD's role argued over how to question Snelling

By Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Shortly after a contentious listening session where dozens of people accused Chicago police of aiding federal agents during Operation Midway Blitz, Angel Rubi Navarajo told Remel Terry, president of the Community Commission for Public Safety and Accountability, that he thought they could be doing more.

"The community feels we have dragged our feet with this topic which I think is sad given we have the word Community in our existence as a city-wide commission," wrote Rubi Navarajo, the commission's vice president.

But even in the following months, records show the primary city agency mandated to act as a civilian-oriented check on Chicago police was hampered by division on how to seek accountability over the blitz. Over time, disagreements between commissioners worsened as they argued over plans to bring then-Supt. Larry Snelling in for a hearing.

In the end, the body largely allowed Snelling to dictate the terms of his appearance.

The commission, established in 2021, is the product of the broadest push for civilian oversight of police Chicago has ever undertaken. It's endowed with real power: aside from shaping the hiring process for CPD's superintendent, drafting general orders and setting goals for the department, the commission can also compel the superintendent or a representative to appear for questioning.

But as Chicagoans took stock of Midway Blitz and considered the possibility that federal agents could eventually return to Chicago in force, the commission's president resisted using the full scope of the body's power to take Snelling to task on how his officers had handled

See **DIVISION** on Page A2



Rachael Van Vechten pays for parking on her phone while her children, Henry and Charles, play with the parking meter box in Lincoln Square on Friday. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Aldermen OK sale of parking meter system

Infamous lease is switching owners as some point to improvements over 2008 deal

By Jake Sheridan and Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The infamous parking meter lease that Chicagoans love to hate is switching hands, with a New York investment firm taking over after aldermen got them to improve the deal.

The City Council on Tuesday approved the sale of the parking meter system to Stonepeak Partners by a 46-3 vote. The firm made key concessions during the final stretch of a monthslong, high-stakes negotiation in order to get

the \$2.53 billion package across the finish line.

While it does not buy back the roughly 36,000 meters across the city, supporters of the transfer framed it as a big improvement over Mayor Richard M. Daley's 2008 sale that's now widely mocked as a boondoggle and viewed as a black mark on the aldermen who voted for it.

"This was the definition of high stakes. I think through gritty and nuanced negotiations, and by facing the hard-hitting truths, I think today we delivered to

all of Chicago a better deal than we delivered in 2008," Finance Committee chair Ald. Pat Dowell, 3rd, said.

The decision allows the system's remaining 57 years on the lease to be sold by the current ownership group controlled by Morgan Stanley to Stonepeak. It got over the finish line with under two days to go before the city faced a deadline to approve the deal or face potentially disastrous arbitration.

After publicly emerging as the prospective buyer this May,

Stonepeak eventually yielded to aldermen who held out on the deal until a benefits package emerged: A \$75 million transfer fee, 2% of any future sale and 5% of the system's calculated net income — altogether around \$140 million in present value, according to Finance Committee vice chair Ald. Bill Conway, 34th.

The official sign-off on the sale faced a false start last Friday, when lead negotiators Dowell and Ald. Scott Waguespack pulled a floor

See **PARKING** on Page A4



White Sox fans Ricardo Duran, from left, Rafael Diaz and Christian Casco cheer after the Sox scored a run in the first inning of their wild-card series game against the Astros, as the group watches the game at Mitchell's Tap in Chicago's Bridgeport neighborhood on Tuesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Batters up, bellies up to local taverns

With the Sox and Cubs both in playoffs, sports bars are busier than ever

By Jane Miller
and Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For the first time since the shortened 2020 season, both of the Windy City's baseball teams have nabbed a spot in the Major League Baseball postseason. Fans across Chicago, from the North Side, South Side and beyond, are ecstatic. No one, however, is more eager than the local sports bars.

"It's amazing," said Carolyn

Mitchell, who owns Mitchell's Tap.

The White Sox and the Cubs had their first games of the wild-card series on Tuesday, with the Sox playing the Houston Astros and the Cubs playing the San Diego Padres. Both games were away, sending fans flooding into local drinking spots.

For two decades, Mitchell's Tap, a sports bar in Bridgeport

See **BARS** on Page A4

2026 POSTSEASON Sox take Game 1

■ The Pope's blessings serve as prelude to a heavenly 6-3 win for the White Sox over the Astros.

■ Pete Crow-Armstrong — with "more to prove" — is eager to help Cubs start the postseason strong.

Coverage in Sports

US bans nearly \$1B worth of imports from Canada

Latest measure in trade war includes alcohol, dairy items, motorcycles

By Paul Wiseman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — U.S.-Canada relations, already tense, are likely to deteriorate further after the United States went ahead early Tuesday with a decision to ban nearly \$1 billion worth of Canadian imports, including alcoholic beverages, dairy products and motorcycles.

The ban amounts to barely a ripple in \$880 billion worth of annual two-way trade between the two northern neighbors. But it marks another ratcheting up of President Donald Trump's second-term trade war with America's longtime ally and trading partner.

The import ban "certainly won't do anything to help the trade tensions between the United States and Canada," said trade attorney

Patrick Childress, a partner at Holland & Knight and a former U.S. trade official.

The latest sparring began over the summer when Trump reached back to a Great Depression law to impose 50% tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of Canadian imports, charging that Canada discriminates against U.S. dairy, auto and alcoholic beverage producers. Canada promptly counterpunched with tariffs of 15%, 25% or 50%, matching U.S. imports dollar for dollar.

To punish Canada for retaliating against his tariffs, Trump decided to ban a list of Canadian products, effective 12:01 a.m. Eastern time Tuesday.

The economic impact is likely to be minimal. Childress noted that the products on the banned list were already facing Trump's tariffs. "For a lot of these goods, the 50% was already acting as a de facto ban by making importation

See **TARIFFS** on Page A11

INSIDE

Lessons through food

How Chicago educator Rita Leary uses food to teach science thanks to Pilot Light, a local chef-led nonprofit. **Food & Health**



Jarrett Payton is 'having a blast'

One month into his tenure as morning show co-host on 104.3 The Score, Jarrett Payton has hit the ground running. **Business**

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 68 L: 66
THU. H: 72 L: 57
FRI. H: 67 L: 52
FULL WEATHER REPORT A10

INDEX

Almanac A11
Arts & Living B8
Comics B12-B13
Crossword B13
Editorials A7
Horoscope B12
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A11
Television B11

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